

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♣

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: East

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 8 4
♥ K 7 5 3
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ 8

♠ K 6 2

♥ A Q

♦ 5 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 5

♥ 10 9 8 4 2

♦ K 8

♣ 10 5 4

♠ A 7 3

♥ J 6

♦ A Q 7 6 2

♣ A 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			
6♣ by North			

You are thinking slam; your first step is a jump to 3♣.

Partner says 4♣;

You are thinking slam; your first step is a jump to 3♣.

Partner says 4♣;

With partner agreeing ♣s, one possibility would be for you to cue-bid your ♥A. Another would be just to bid 6♣. You choose the second approach.

North plays 6♣. East leads the ♥10. West plays low and you win the ♥Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

Your best chance at another winner is the ♦ suit. East MAY have both the ♦ K Q, if not you will have to establish the suit.

At trick 2 pull just one round of trumps with the ♣K. Then play a small ♦, finessing the ♦J when East plays low. West takes the ♦Q and returns the ♠J.

Go up with your ♠K, you may need the entry to dummy later. Pull one more trump with the ♣Q, then play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A. Ruff a ♦ with a high trump, East discarding.

Enter dummy with the ♣A, pulling East's last trump as you do, and ruff one more ♦, establishing the fifth ♦. Enter dummy with the ♠A and discard your losing ♠ on the good ♦.

It is important to be careful with entries to the hand where you are trying to establish a suit.

If the suit splits evenly perhaps you can be a little sloppy and still get by.

But in cases like this one, with a 4-2 split, you cannot afford to waste an entry too early.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6
♥ A 7 5 3 2
♦ 7 6 4 2
♣ 8 5 4

♠ K 7 4 3
♥ Q 10 9 4
♦ J 10
♣ K 10 7

W N
S E

♠ A 10 5 2
♥ 8 6
♦ A K 3
♣ A 9 6 2

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ K J
♦ Q 9 8 5
♣ Q J 3

West	North	East	South
2♦	Pass	1NT	Pass
All Pass			

2♥ by East
to say that 1NT would be an inferior contract. Here's a suggestion - with fewer than 9 points and a 5-card Major transfer to that suit when you have a singleton, pass with no singleton. So here you bid 2♦ and partner says 2♥.

Of course you pass, that was the whole point of the transfer.

The contract would be 2♥ played by West.

East plays 2♥. South leads the ♠Q, North playing the ♠7.

We will all agree that you win the first trick with your ♠A.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 2/3/? : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = lots

In suit contracts it is usual to count losers. Sometimes in low level suit contracts it makes things clearer if you count winners. Here you have 4 high card winners in your hand plus the Ace of trumps in dummy.

Your plan will therefore be to make as many of dummy's small trumps as you can.

At trick 2 ruff a ♠ in dummy. Pull one trump with the ♥A. Play a ♣ back to your ♣A and ruff another ♠.

Got the idea? Play a ♦ to your ♦K and ruff your last ♠ in dummy. Then play the ♦A. If you've been counting you have taken the first 8 tricks. A good thing, too, because you aren't going to take any more.

In most suit contracts it is good to pull trumps early.

Here is an example of when that principle is **NOT** correct; when you need to get several ruffs with small trumps.

This situation comes up a lot. You don't have enough points to advance partner's 1NT opening, but you have a "long suit" that might play better than notrump. If "long suit" is 6 ♥s or 6 ♠s then pretty clearly you should transfer partner to that suit and then pass. But with only 5 of the Major it is tougher to say that 1NT would be an inferior contract. Here's a suggestion - with fewer than 9 points and a 5-card Major, transfer to that suit when you have a singleton or void, otherwise pass 1NT. So here you bid 2♦ and partner says 2♥.

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